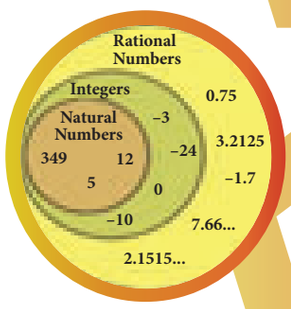
1 NUMBERS



Learning Objectives

- To understand the necessity for extending fractions to rational numbers, to represent rational numbers on the number line and to know that between any two given rational numbers, there lies many rational numbers.
- To learn and perform the four basic arithmetic operations and solve word problems on rational numbers and simplify expressions with atmost three brackets.
- To understand the properties of rational numbers.
- To compute the square, the square root, the cube and the cube root of numbers.
- To make a rough estimate of the square roots and the cube roots of numbers.
- To express numbers in exponential form and understand the laws of exponents with integral powers.
- To identify and express the numbers in scientific notation.

B7XMD8

1.1 Introduction

Let us recall the different types of numbers which we have already learnt in our earlier classes. When we want to count, it is natural to start with numbers 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, … Isn't it?

These are all called as **Counting numbers** or **Natural numbers** and their collection is denoted by **ℕ**. The use of three dots at the end of the list is a notation to show that the list keeps going forever.

The natural numbers can be visualized as a ray marked with these numbers:



Fig 1.1

Consider the situation that yesterday my purse had money, say ₹8, but today the purse may be empty. How many rupees are there in the purse now? How to denote this emptiness? Here comes the concept of zero which evolved to symbolize the idea of emptiness. The concept of zero, though quite natural now, was not normal to early humans. Only after hundreds of years people started thinking of it as an actual number. The difficulty was solved when the Indian Mathematicians provided the symbol for zero. The natural numbers system

01_8th_Maths_Numbers_Chap 1.indd 1 2/12/2020 12:03:05 PM